



THE FIGHT FOR AMERICA'S FAMILIES

Exposing the Corruption in Family Courts and CPS.

They took my kids. They tried to silence me. They WON'T.

FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 25

MISSOURI

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — the first cross-state dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Missouri's family courts and child-welfare system.

146

MISSOURI FAMILIES ON RECORD ·
265 CHILDREN IMPACTED · 24
MONTHS MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF
PARENTING TIME

REPORT GENERATED

MAY 16, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED

53 OF 115

COMPILED BY

MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

MISSOURI AT A GLANCE.

Across 146 Missouri families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 265 146 of 146 families reported child counts	MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN \$106,000 median across 65 families reporting 3+ categories	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 24 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 54.1% 35.6% after running out of money
SUBMISSIONS 146	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 1.8	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN 146 of 146	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 53

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Missouri families — and families in every state — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

02 THE COST OF MISSOURI FAMILY COURT

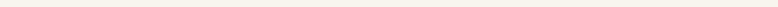
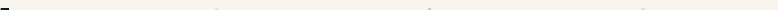
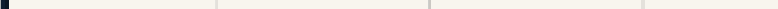
Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

Expense Category	Responses	Median	Mean	Total Reported
Attorney Fees	91	\$20,000	\$44,359	\$4,036,700
Lost Wages	70	\$10,000	\$129,174	\$9,042,169
Other Court Fees	48	\$500	\$5,091	\$244,390
Therapy / Evaluations	63	\$1,000	\$3,579	\$225,490
Reunification Services	38	\$0	\$2,076	\$78,900
GAL Fees	77	\$2,500	\$6,155	\$473,956
Asset Loss ¹	59	\$30,000	—	—
Median Family Burden (65 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	\$106,000	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least \$1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median (\$30,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost		24	2 yrs
Mean months lost		38	3.2 yrs
Total across all families		3,661	305.1 yrs

03 WHO IS REPORTING · MISSOURI

Most families documenting in Missouri are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed		61	42%
Not provided		36	25%
Case closed: within last 2 years		22	15%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago		21	14%
Not in court but still affected		3	2%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and CPS		70	48%
Family Court Only		42	29%
Unknown		20	14%
CPS (Child Protective Services) Only		14	10%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years		49	34%
3 – 5 years		27	18%
5 – 10 years		16	11%
Over 10 years		15	10%
6 months – 1 year		10	7%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Loss of Access		35	24%
50/50 Joint		32	22%
Visitation Only		31	21%
Children in Foster Care		17	12%
Full Custody		14	10%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Jackson		8	5%
Jefferson		7	5%
Jasper		6	4%
Cass		5	3%
Phelps		5	3%
St. Charles		4	3%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)		37	25%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)		29	20%
High Conflict Divorce		15	10%
Other: (Short answer)		15	10%
Medical CPS (Medical Child Abuse allegations, disagreement with doctors)		9	6%

04 PARENT VOICES — MISSOURI

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Missouri comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.



An attorney who practices in my county is a party to this case and has had 100% control and influence on the judges actions and decisions in both of the cases where my children have been stolen from me due to lies and false allegations about me.

— SARAH

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

False accusations removed me from family home. Lost union job for a year 100,000+ in wages. Fraudulent family court dismissed my testimony and evidence in court trial filing judgements against me that ultimately allowed my ex wife to get home all 67 ac of farm by adopting her [...]

— MISSOURI PARENT · STEVEN

MORE VOICES FROM MISSOURI

Took all 3 of my kids on false accusations labeled me as unstable bc I was emotional. I quit my job and cosmology school to go to rehab like cps wanted and they terminated my rights while I was in a 30 day program they wanted me to go to. My court appointed attorney was no help. [...]

— JESSICA

Have destroyed our relationships with our children cause emotional trauma to our two-year-old. My wife now suffers from PTSD and anxiety.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This has damaged our Family, Our Children have been traumatized by this so badly that we can see how much they are hurting, Children should not have to suffer because of people who are corrupt..

— BENJAMIN

Lied and destroyed my family along with trying to brainwash my children.

— DJ

04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Destroyed the honor in raising my own kids and completely destroyed the relationship at all costs.

— JAYMEE

The court system has traumatized me and my children held me away from my children and falsely accused me. We have been harassed by CPS workers and threatened by the supervisors

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Traumatized my grandchildren , now in therapy, children's behavior has changed dramatically. Given my grandchildren ptsd

— PATTI

This system has traumatized my babies, myself and their father. When your heartbroken didn't even get to speak also false allegations.

— MEAGHAN

Have removed all 6 of my kids just for them to hurt everyday like me n one of my child had a liver transplant that I couldn't attend due to cps no contact rules wen illegally removed my kids

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Has ripped my family apart these are my adopted grandchildren and my adopted daughter's children. They have traumatized all of us and changed our lives forever!

— SHAWNIA

Repeatedly traumatized and abused my children. Whom now suffer CPTSD and DID.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

What was done to us wasn't justice; it was trauma dressed up as procedure, leaving my children and our family to carry wounds we never caused.

— COURTNEY

"The court took my children based on a lie and no one was held accountable.

— SARAH

04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Taken my children away from a loving stable home in favor of custody with their father who had Dr documented child abuse against said kids. The emotional damage done to myself and my children will leave permanent scars

— KERI

Trauma. Injustice. Depression (2 years of severe depression) 10 years later this is what I still think about daily ,im scared to send my kids to school with even so much as dirty nails, they take children for less than that. I see the cases here & they are disgusting. Since this [...]

— JENNIFER

Family court actors are causing more trauma, above what children have already lived through. Believe the children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has used my kids to financially extort my ex and myself. My children are the collateral damage.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have destroyed my life getting an opportunity to raise my children right.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed faith in police, courts, judges, all actors. We are 4th generation business owners, philanthropists, and no much more than speeding tickets in our entire family, all this was done by a unelected prosecutor for a soon be ex spouse from Brazil with 2 dwis with kids [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Pro Se is not a bad option looking back. All the time, stress and energy getting info, going to appointments, taking phone calls and finding more ways to make money to pay an attorney-that is really not looking out for your child or you like they say 99.8% of the time, can just [...]

— SARAH

Completely destroyed us by tearing us apart without hearing our evidence and placing my children in the hands of a pedophile

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

All of our kids were so loved. They were never abused or neglected. In our Petition and amended petition 3 months later, It states Mathew was not in the home when search warrant was served, Mathew is not in judicial custody. That in a lie. Chief of police came and took Mathew [...]

— JACQUELINE

04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Stolen and destroyed relationships, forever sad and heartbroken.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Unsure- StandwithMegs legal advice cost me everything.

— NANCY

My children will forever lives be effected. My life will never be same,currently I feel im lost without them.

— VIRGINIA

Has gutted the core of our family my other children miss their sister and that has been just as hard as missing her myself

— JESSICA

Completely destroyed my family. Made me question if leaving an abusive partner was worth it.

— CHEYANNE

It has been unfair and corrupt causing undue stress, financial hardship, panic and anxiety attacks, ptsd, and a total loss of trust in the legal system.

— LOVETTA

It destroyed it and now I'm rebuilding it

— AIMEE

We've been denied access, visitation, alienated from my grandchildren, I was personally escorted out of the hospital in front of my grandchildren

— PATTI

Completely made me lose hope in the system in doing right by all citizens and protecting the best interests of our kids and our all around rights as parents and citizens

— BRITNEE

Ripped us apart, broken bond with kids, alienation etc

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They allowed my abusive exact buy 50/50 custody and continue his abuse post divorce.

— DEBBIE

04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



My husband immediately requested a GAL before any hearings had taken place. I agreed thinking that having someone speak for my child would be helpful. The GAL has created an absolute witch hunt on me. She has tried to use my trauma diagnosis of things like PTSD as "proof" of me [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have destroyed my family and ruined my relationship with my 13 yr old. My 17, 10 and 6 yr old hate their dad

— TARA

St Charles County Family Court was complicit in the complete alienation of my children and total financial ruin that I will likely never recover from.

— MEAGHEHN

Kidnapped my daughter, separation trauma, told lies about me to my daughter. Distrust of the system.

— REBECCA

They are allowing a mother that is mentally and physically abusive to hold custody and use the system that she works in to shield abuse and constitutional violations. Judge called her abusive on the first page of the order.

— SHANE

It has broken my family apart to where my kids was always with me every single day. Not with there dad's at all i was fighting to get child support on both dad's before the courts did take my children. Right now I just can't think clearly.

— HOLLI

Destroyed us as well and making sure we had no financials to live basic lives.

— VICTORIA

They allowed my abuser to continue to abuse me by way of parental alienation. Even grown the relationships are so complicated because of.

— LEEANN

This system has ripped the goodness and joy from my family and mentally emotionally tortured myself and my daughters

— ABIGAIL

107 Missouri parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 44 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — MISSOURI

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Missouri families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

An attorney who practices in my county is a party to this case and has had 100% control and influence on the judges actions and decisions in both of the cases where my children have been stolen from me due to lies and false allegations about me.

— SARAH

False accusations removed me from family home. Lost union job for a year 100,000+ in wages. Fraudulent family court dismissed my testimony and evidence in court trial filing judgements against me that ultimately allowed my ex wife to get home all 67 ac of farm by adopting her lies at trial as truth. She claimed assets owned by others failed to report marital debt all to come out with an extreme favorable judgement. False accusations required me to take 26 wk domestic violence class and 8 wk anger control. Completed 26 wk class virtual, now still trying to cause problems through court with that. Still don't have my personal items from marital home and she has not refinanced the home as court ordered her to do over 8 months ago. At the beginning my kids were kept away from me for 6 months going through multiple attorneys until I finally got visitation a few months before trial.

— STEVEN

Took all 3 of my kids on false accusations labeled me as unstable bc I was emotional. I quit my job and cosmology school to go to rehab like cps wanted and they terminated my rights while I was in a 30 day program they wanted me to go to. My court appointed attorney was no help. I wasn't even there to defend myself. It gets worse!

— JESSICA

Have destroyed our relationships with our children cause emotional trauma to our two-year-old. My wife now suffers from PTSD and anxiety.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This has damaged our Family, Our Children have been traumatized by this so badly that we can see how much they are hurting, Children should not have to suffer because of people who are corrupt..

— BENJAMIN

Lied and destroyed my family along with trying to brainwash my children.

— DJ

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Destroyed the honor in raising my own kids and completely destroyed the relationship at all costs .

— JAYMEE

The court system has traumatized me and my children held me away from my children and falsely accused me. We have been harassed by CPS workers and threatened by the supervisors

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Traumatized my grandchildren , now in therapy, children's behavior has changed dramatically. Given my grandchildren ptsd

— PATTI

This system has traumatized my babies, myself and their father. When your heartbroken didn't even get to speak also false allegations.

— MEAGHAN

Have removed all 6 of my kids just for them to hurt everyday like me n one of my child had a liver transplant that I couldn't attend due to cps no contact rules wen illegally removed my kids

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Has ripped my family apart these are my adopted grandchildren and my adopted daughter's children. They have traumatized all of us and changed our lives forever!

— SHAWNIA

Repeatedly traumatized and abused my children. Whom now suffer CPTSD and DID.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

What was done to us wasn't justice; it was trauma dressed up as procedure, leaving my children and our family to carry wounds we never caused.

— COURTNEY

"The court took my children based on a lie and no one was held accountable.

— SARAH

Taken my children away from a loving stable home in favor of custody with their father who had Dr documented child abuse against said kids. The emotional damage done to myself and my children will leave permanent scars

— KERI

Trauma. Injustice. Depression (2 years of severe depression) 10 years later this is what I still think about daily ,im scared to send my kids to school with even so much as dirty nails, they take children for less than that. I see the cases here & they are disgusting. Since this happened all I have wanted to do is advocate for poor families, cps tricks you into signing things & do all sorts of things even I didnt know,but all ive done for the last few years is read about cases & the injustice & watched videos & learned laws. However I cant leave my town of 5000 (dad has visitation) I am TERRIFIED that as long as my children are school age, there could be retaliation. This bothers & angers me immensely. Nobody should have to worry 1 angry ex hotline call, or just a cps made up lie & it could happen all over or much worse!

— JENNIFER

Family court actors are causing more trauma, above what children have already lived through. Believe the children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has used my kids to financially extort my ex and myself. My children are the collateral damage.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

They have destroyed my life getting an opportunity to raise my children right.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed faith in police, courts, judges, all actors. We are 4th generation business owners, philanthropists, and no much more than speeding tickets in our entire family, all this was done by a unelected prosecutor for a soon be ex spouse from Brazil with 2 dwis with kids (8,2) in car, 3 rehab stay, the overdose incident, and after that, drunk in court and beat up by abusive partners (married couple took her in as 3rd party sex toy physical abuse) her BAC with the kids on Jan 21 was in excess of .50, never been charged with any violation except a misdemeanor dwi

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Pro Se is not a bad option looking back. All the time, stress and energy getting info, going to appointments, taking phone calls and finding more ways to make money to pay an attorney-that is really not looking out for your child or you like they say 99.8% of the time, can just as reasonably jump in to reading laws, studying cases, filling out forms, going to open court hearings and see the judge and attorneys in action, and presenting your own case. Sounds intimidating and it seems like the courts don't want you to do it because it's harder for them, attorneys don't want you to do it because it takes their job, but you can do it. Now it's easier than ever. Know your rights and the laws- attorney represented or pro se.

— SARAH

Completely destroyed us by tearing us apart without hearing our evidence and placing my children in the hands of a pedophile

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

All of our kids were so loved. They were never abused or neglected. In our Petition and amended petition 3 months later, It states Mathew was not in the home when search warrant was served, Mathew is not in judicial custody. That in a lie. Chief of police came and took Mathew the day after search warrant was served. Leaving no paperwork whatsoever. 4 days after he was taken Children's Division was applying for federal funding for Mathew.

— JACQUELINE

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Stolen and destroyed relationships, forever sad and heartbroken.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Unsure- StandwithMegs legal advice cost me everything.

— NANCY

My children will forever lives be effected. My life will never be same,currently I feel im lost without them.

— VIRGINIA

Has gutted the core of our family my other children miss their sister and that has been just as hard as missing her myself

— JESSICA

Completely destroyed my family. Made me question if leaving an abusive partner was worth it.

— CHEYANNE

It has been unfair and corrupt causing undue stress, financial hardship, panic and anxiety attacks, ptsd, and a total loss of trust in the legal system.

— LOVETTA

It destroyed it and now I'm rebuilding it

— AIMEE

We've been denied access, visitation, alienated from my grandchildren, I was personally escorted out of the hospital in front of my grandchildren

— PATTI

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Completely made me lose hope in the system in doing right by all citizens and protecting the best interests of our kids and our all around rights as parents and citizens

— BRITNEE

Ripped us apart, broken bond with kids, alienation etc

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They allowed my abusive exact buy 50/50 custody and continue his abuse post divorce.

— DEBBIE

My husband immediately requested a GAL before any hearings had taken place. I agreed thinking that having someone speak for my child would be helpful. The GAL has created an absolute witch hunt on me. She has tried to use my trauma diagnosis of things like PTSD as "proof" of me being unfit, rather than proof of my husband's abuse even after I had informed her of the abuse. She has subjected me to evaluations and required that I sign up for SoberLink alcohol monitoring because I had a DUI, not during parenting time, that I've been charged with while escaping another abusive partner. She is misrepresenting the data that has show 3 small blips of alcohol over 4 months. All were residual mouth alcohol from fruit juice or extracts. They all dropped consistent with residual mouth alcohol and not consumption, yet she has insisted in court that this blips prove that I have a drinking problem. She has called my lawyer and tried to convince him that I do not even want my child and that I find her too difficult. My lawyer is not responding to emails and is showing up unprepared and is agreeing to even blatant lies about me. This is my third lawyer and this has happened every time. A year ago my mother and sister repeatedly assaulted me in front of my child. They insisted that I had assaulted them repeatedly. My daughter's dad immediately filed a motion for emergency full custody based on their false allegations and withheld my child for 2 months until the matter was reviewed by the Court and denied. Although their claims were later disproved by video surveillance, he still claims that I was the aggressor and even though it was denied by the court, he believes that he did nothing

— ANONYMOUS PARENT (1/2)

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

wrong and doesn't have to make up the time or take account for the damages done to my child. He continues that allow my child to be alone with my family. She comes back completely dysregulated every time. There was also a hotline call from the nurse at my daughter's school about my daughter asking the nurse to play out sexual acts with her. My husband has violated even the temporary parenting plan already slanted heavily in his favor,

— ANONYMOUS PARENT (2/2)

They have destroyed my family and ruined my relationship with my 13 yr old. My 17, 10 and 6 yr old hate their dad

— TARA

St Charles County Family Court was complicit in the complete alienation of my children and total financial ruin that I will likely never recover from.

— MEAGHN

Kidnapped my daughter, separation trauma, told lies about me to my daughter. Distrust of the system.

— REBECCA

They are allowing a mother that is mentally and physically abusive to hold custody and use the system that she works in to shield abuse and constitutional violations. Judge called her abusive on the first page of the order.

— SHANE

It has broken my family apart to where my kids was always with me every single day. Not with there dad's at all i was fighting to get child support on both dad's before the courts did take my children. Right now I just can't think clearly.

— HOLLI

Destroyed us as well and making sure we had no financials to live basic lives.

— VICTORIA

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

They allowed my abuser to continue to abuse me by way of parental alienation. Even grown the relationships are so complicated because of.

— LEEANN

This system has ripped the goodness and joy from my family and mentally emotionally tortured myself and my daughters

— ABIGAIL

Took away my ability to provide for myself, to save or build and stole the assets built for the kids future. Where there was a strong bond of love and protection, joy and connection was replaced with disregard, anger, and displacement. My oldest daughter is now a prosecutor for family court learning to rake in \$ like her mom and grandparents. My middle daughter completed her nursing degree and works for medical industrial complex making money hurting ppl without knowing what she's doing. My youngest son wants nothing to do with a healthy relationship with someone as he sees what happens to families. He lives with his uncle and has no interest in accomplishing anything. They are all grown bullies with stone hearts. Communication is more than fractured and I am disabled veteran who's done 7 months for being broke. My wife was also thrown in jail by this judge for telling him to recognize the fraud.

— DALAS

The system is failed. This statement was said by the attorney, mediator which was a retired judge of 30 years. I have lost my assets that I was owed. It showed me that the courts do not help the innocent.

— ERIC

The family court system weaponized my parenting constantly keeping me and my kids in fight or flight

— MEGHANN

They are trying to destroy my family for no reason just so they can have a kid for the federal funds.

— CARRIE

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Shifted attention away from my children and onto my ex

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It broke me to the point im unhappy with everything no interest in living life without my children

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Lied directly to a judge about her clients criminal case and falsified a timeline of his imprisonment.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This corrupt system has stolen my children from me, my children has been alienated from me and has been moved to 4 homes in 8 months. I have missed thanksgiving and Christmas and birthdays. My daughter has been molested and they just denied it and covered it up by moving her. My PTSD and anxiety has been at the all time highest it has ever been to which I must go to therapy every week and take medication every day. My daughter is completely different now that she has been away from us. My son has been completely cut off from us and my heart is broken.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I showed up to court and asked for a continuance to find an attorney and they closed my case

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have kidnapped a child from this family on false allegation and all medical evidence contradicts it and put us through emotional hell and still won't let us see or bring him back home ..

— CRYSTAL

The system is so disconnected from God it not even right making family spilt up for false allegations there need to be standard put in place.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Destroyed it. And I have tons of proof they made it all up. State actors. I won my appeal 3 years later so they later helped Oregon finish us off. I have the emails still proving it.

— ERIC

The judge never let my put in my evidence

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Completely shattered it and to pieces.

— JESSI

The family court system has been devastating. My children's childhoods have been overshadowed by their mother's hatred of me, expressed through a prolonged series of litigations attempting to restrict and/or remove my custody. I love my kids and miss them every day.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Tore us apart, and because my ex husband is abusive to me even today with how he controls our autistic son, my son and our relationship will never be the same. The damage it has done to my son can NEVER BE FIXED, LIFE LONG TRAUMA

— SHELLIE

We no longer feel human. Weare held hostage by malicious prosecution in a place we do not feel safe because we are not safe. Our kids ask why Missouri wants to hurt us and to that we have no answer as nothing exists for this to be warranted.

— RACHAEL

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I was a stay at home mom to my three boys. I did everything with, and for, my boys- school stuff, doctor appts, extracurriculars, etc. After divorce, we shared 50/50- week on, week off. Last year, my ex decided to move an hour away to be with his girlfriend, and decided to take them away from everything and everyone they ever knew under false allegations and scaring the boys into going along with it. The judge ignored medical documentation of physical and verbal abuse. I now see them every other weekend.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The girls lost an entire family who loved them. I live every day in bereavement of a living family, murdered in civil court.

— LEONARD

Destroyed my entire life and my relationship with my son

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has tried to creat division for me and my family.

— KESHIA

Deprivation of my God given right to be a mother .

— JACQULYN

I am a recovering addict and have been clean for 7 years. My children have not lived with me since my addiction came to light 7 years ago. My kids were taken, I got clean and did everything the system asked. But they still wouldn't give them back. My daughter is home full time and has been for 2 years but I am still fighting family court for my boys to come home from the guardianship. The system tricked me into thinking guardianship was the best option(I did not have a lawyer present) and after I went with guardianship, they did not include visitation rights in the agreement like we discussed. So after my dfs case closed, I didn't get to see my boys for almost a year. Until i opened up another court case with family court. The system allowed my daughters dad to move 10 hours away with her and I didn't get to see her for 2 years. I have never lost parental rights and was supposed to have 50/50 custody when he ran off with her. The court did not make him come back.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

“The system has caused prolonged separation within my family without clear guidance or timelines, creating emotional and developmental harm to my children and limiting my ability to actively parent despite my stability and compliance.”

— TIFFANY

The family court system has taken irreplaceable time from our family, enabled alienation and stripped away childhood, motherhood, and the close family bonds without transparency or accountability and we continue to pay the price.

— AMANDA

Separated siblings, a loving parent from a meaningful relationship.

— NICHOLE

traumatized me and scared to answer the door. i had black out panic attacks while i was locked up , had to go to the hospital for severe chest pains ,lost weight to point i had to go the hospital, caused my son to self harm and attacked me and biting while holding him , has put my son in constant panic attacks being forced to keep my kid inside as the opposite outside helps my kid calm down, torn apart me and mother relationship dealing with her doing drugs and drinking, drained my pockets and schedule putting more effort into people that don't care instead of putting time for my child. restricted me from travel and job opportunities as i'm on probation due to coercion and bribery. it is illegal for any body of government to do this vs a civilian due process of a vote in the court room. many sleepless nights just trying to door dash for my kid cause i spent my check on other issues to me and other situations afloat. burning bridges with family ties and support. traumatized from the many state workers laughing at me as i come from the system adopted from Romania as a child coming to this country 4-5 years old now seeing my kid going thru this. Revelation Poets is my fb.

— TIMOTHY

This court allowed an exparte that was based on lies, to run throughout the entirety of the case. This prevented me from accessing my children fully for almost 3 years. Both kiddos now have PTSD from the separation.

— JESSICA

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

St Francois County, MO. Is completely corrupt in every way and we cannot find anyone who will stand up to this system that continuously fails not only my child, my spouse, and myself, but so many other families. When is enough going to be enough?

— LEEANNA

It has caused nothing but stress, heartbreak and anxiety for everyone involved

— JESSIE

Forced my children to grow up without a mother. They are teenagers now and they started when they were toddlers. They put me into poverty prevented my children from having a safe family home, prevented my kids from having a stable home eventually put my kids into a one bedroom apartment with two documented abusive men. Good job.

— ANGIE

It turned our lives upside down—creating stress, confusion, and heartache. Nothing but a money-hungry system that profits off families' pain.

— SARA

Completely destroy everything they touch!! Crimes against humanity!

— KEITH

The court has destroyed me and my daughters, who are not allowed to even talk about me, as well as my older son (different father) who was very close to his sisters. The court has given all power to a seriously (documented & untreated) mentally ill father who happens to have a lot of money.

— RACHAEL

Completely ripped us apart.

— LACY

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I was taken to court so my ex could lower his child support and get out of paying back expenses of almost 30k. Family court is a money making scam where only the kids lose.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My daughter was ripped out of my life for no reason because someone that had possession of her lied to get emergency guardianship. This person ain't even related and my daughter was reported missing. But nobody cares.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has severely effected my bonding with my daughter. She hardly sees her mother as her mother. We lost out on so many of her first important moments.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Lost everything. Hid finances. Therapist terrified my child. Did not listen to her at 12 years old. Kept me quiet or threatened I would be held in contempt. Sides with abusive x

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Lost faith in truth and transparency or due process. Lived in survival mode surrounding myself with cameras for 3 years.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My daughter is 3, we left the house when she was 2. My ex beat her daily. He beat the dog. I have eye witness accounts. The GAL and judge did nothing to protect my child. When she came home from a 3 hour visit, she told me, "Daddy hit me." I reported it to the GAL and he responded, "well she's only 3 so that really doesn't hold any weight."

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The system has failed my son both mentally and emotionally as his father denied him counseling, denied him access to better schools and allowed his child to be bullied and abused by the very students and staff he was forced to surround himself with. He developed severe health issues because of it.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ripped my son completely away from his home and ALL of his family and ordered him to move to Alaska with strangers. (His father and step mom) My son was a 4.0 student and now barely passing his freshman year of high school due to the forced move. We will never trust any court official ever again.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

absolutely unbelievable & barbarically devastating. A silent genocide to the foundation of families, using one's own family to help & progress their agenda. Sickening and inhumane to hear, despite the odds that we survive this, it's nearly a death sentence that will be a lifetime worth of grief and suffering. "Mom you think you had it bad losing your kids, I once thought you were dead for like a year and I had to live with them! Sure you are not happy about missing your kids but I had to live with THEM!!"

— JACINDA

Clay County Missouri placed my child with a documented violent predator. They usurped jurisdiction and have crossed state lines to solicit help from Wyandotte county and Johnson county judges in Kansas. Family court is the reason why Missouri is #4 on the FBI child human and sex trafficking list. Kansas is just as bad. These judges are criminals and deserve to be in jail for the destruction they've caused to me and my family.

— ANNETTE

The system came in careless for our struggles, only focusing on the faults accusations and harrassing us even after they were proven faults.. they lied, decieved, manipulated and silenced my family while we screamed for help..

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The loss of my wife's business due to harassment false allegations under the anonymous covering that started the day after we got married and has since being ongoing for three years the loss of time with my son I didn't even get to see him till right before his first birthday and then I had to pay to have supervised visits hundreds hundreds of dollars I had to do all the travel to pick up and drop off at her work when we finally did get equal custody and she had child support ordered, even though I was doing the travel time if I were to get a job, I'd lose custody time because of the right of first refusal so it made really working difficult but my wife's job allowed me to be able to stay home with him while I stayed in communication. I'm partially paid child support. She said she really didn't need it, but her attorney told her to put it in there because that made the court look at her as the custodial parent she has used law-enforcement to file false allegations, including police reports, she's used my oldest daughter whose not around and hates my wife as it means to cause disruption and fights and arguments one-sided my wife doesn't my daughter does in front of the child or child or three-year-old her and my ex-wife buddy and Dave called the law they have stocked. They have made false allegation after false allegation and substantiated. The harassment is really too much. It's like something you would see on a lifetime movie.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ruined everything. Everything.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has failed me and allowed my kids to remain with their mother without looking at all the evidence. My oldest wont talk to me and I have a restraining order against me from her and I get two little supervised visit hours to try and remain connected to my other daughter.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Parenting time reduced or suspended without findings of abuse Temporary orders lasting months or years Court delays while contact is denied Allegations later dismissed but access not restored Reunification therapy ordered after damage is severe Enforcement motions ignored or minimized Since court involvement began, the child's relationship with the undersigned parent has deteriorated rapidly. Temporary orders and procedural delays—though not intended to cause harm—have resulted in prolonged separation without substantiated findings of abuse. This has unintentionally reinforced the child's rejection and undermined the parent-child bond.”

— CHELSEA

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The system has completely taken everything away from me and my family. The irreccable damage that has been done are things that will never be completely healed.

— CASSANDRA

My son has autism , mostly non verbal and epilepsy. I'm sure he has no idea what's happening and why I m not taking him with me when I leave our visit. He probably thinks I don't love him or care , he will never know I cry for him daily and worry about him non-stop.

— SHONDA

Recurring intergenerational court involvement and repeated law-enforcement contact have resulted in prolonged instability, internal displacement, and significant psychological harm, ultimately undermining my sense of safety and trust in public institutions. These conditions have directly affected my willingness and ability to pursue family reunification, as the cumulative impact of administrative and enforcement actions has created an environment that does not feel safe or protective for my children.

— NATALIE

The system allowed half of my child's world of healthy and meaningful connections and relationships to be shut off, erased, and rewritten. We (family, friends, the future) are forever changed and will likely always carry a certain amount of fear.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system did not just take away years of parenting time — it took away everyday moments, memories, stability, and the chance for my children to grow up with their father consistently in their lives. No parent can ever truly get back the lost years, missed milestones, and emotional damage caused by prolonged separation.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

From birth to 2 years ongoing denial of kinshipcare for granddaughter although I was licensed and recommended in home study. Continual pergerly with NO accountability

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

These people have an agreement to violate the laws of the United States and they do engage in acts in violation of RICO so I want prosecution of these people for destroying my family, stealing our savings and permanently disfiguring my son.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has created a year in school, where my daughter has performed the least successfully she has regressing from threes and above into ones. My son has missed the most days out of the school year. He possibly can. My daughter had to be put in achievement court because of how bad her grades are she has lost out on other school activities and getting to participate in corral which she auditioned for and got because my coparent does not do homework with her. She has fallen behind a minimum of 100 homework assignments just the semester and I have done my work during my limited time with them catching her up on every homework assignment. My son has missed more days out of the school year this year than he ever did before. Both children are experiencing emotional disturbances, nightmare, nightmares, bad wedding, and emotional meltdowns, which are on video and have been recorded.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Instead of actually looking for a scenario of reunification, they have found ways to extend. They have said statements such as the child is in immediate risk of death or danger. Our children have been given access to areas that could create more danger. They're finding ways to help manipulate our children and our children are manipulating each other. There's so much alienation going on for my husband and I. They have pulled in other parents that the children may have outside of my husband and I and giving them more access whether that's what the custody agreements say or not. And one scenario I have full custody of my daughter and she has had full contact with her biodad who has been completely out of the picture.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system investigated an accusation made by my ex over five years ago. Now my ex is claiming the same thing from the same incident in order to alienate me from my child and to get full custody and supervised visits only.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Obliterated my life with a financial and reputational bomb of slander that has locked even my own Mother up in a mental ward where she was killed and banned of visitors as she was confined to a small room with white walls and no company or entertainment. They faked her diagnosis as Alzheimer's and then drugged her up into wheelchair bound then bed bound and banned her of visitors. Worse than prison. The grandmother of the children was a living witness to their Holocaust and child mass thriving. They have their eye on my lot in IL and my parents house in MO. The govt steals mercilessly and follows occultic church commandments "Thous shalt steal. Thous shalt kill." Horrifying the USA has so many hostages they take as an organized plot to overtake civil assets. US terrorism is worse here than the Middle East.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The Court has single handedly shown me that the justice system is deeply flawed and needs reformed in order to protect the constitutional liberties We, The People truly have.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This unjust system has shattered my very family, ripping us apart when we should have been whole. The pain runs deep, knowing that our bonds have been forever changed, lost in a sea of unfairness. I have missed the most precious milestones, moments of joy, pride, and love that I fought so hard to witness (and deserved to be at), and now, they are forever out of reach. The ache of these lost memories will haunt me forever, a cruel reminder of what was taken from us.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

107 full approved Missouri comments are included in this appendix.

06 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a national, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Missouri report comes from Missouri respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Missouri — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 146 Missouri families reporting here are not the universe of Missouri families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. We flag outliers and report medians when means are distorted (see page 3, note 1). The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – May 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

When a respondent's financial entry differs from the population by more than three standard deviations, the mean is suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte-Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

[STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com) · COURAGE TO STAND, POWER TO CHANGE

ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

[STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com) | COURAGE TO STAND, POWER TO CHANGE.